Fields (the Landau–Lifshitz textbook on general relativity) would be modified to remove the claim that implosion does not produce singularities.

I carried the manuscript to America, hidden among my personal papers, and it was published. The Soviet authorities never noticed.

Why was it a British physicist (Penrose) and not an American or French or Soviet physicist who introduced topological methods into relativity research? And why was it that throughout the 1960s, topological methods were pursued with vigor and success by other British relativity physicists, but took hold much more slowly in America, France, the U.S.S.R., and elsewhere?

The reason, I suspect, was the undergraduate training of British theoretical physicists. They typically major in mathematics as undergraduates, then do Ph.D. research in departments of applied mathematics or departments of applied mathematics and theoretical physics. In America, by contrast, aspiring theoretical physicists typically major in physics as undergraduates, and then do Ph.D. research in physics departments. Thus, young British theoretical physicists are well versed in esoteric branches of mathematics which have not yet seen much physics application, but they may have a weak background in "gutsy" physics topics such as the behaviors of molecules, atoms, and atomic nuclei. By contrast, young American theoretical physicists know little mathematics beyond what their physics professors have taught them, but are deeply versed in the lore of molecules, atoms, and nuclei.

To a great extent, we Americans have dominated theoretical physics since World War II, and we have foisted on the world's physics community our scandalously low mathematical standards. Most of us use the mathematics of fifty years ago and are incapable of communicating with modern mathematicians. With our poor mathematical training, it was difficult for us Americans to absorb and start using the topological methods when Penrose introduced them.

French theoretical physicists, even more than the British, are well trained in mathematics. However, during the 1960s and 1970s French relativity theorists were so wrapped up in mathematical rigor (that is, perfection), and so deemphasized physical intuition, that they contributed little to our understanding of imploding stars and black holes. Their quest for rigor slowed them down to the point that, although they knew well the